

Siyoung Lee

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EDUCATION

Sogang University, Republic of Korea
M.A. in Economics (in progress, GPA: 4.30/4.30)

Sep 2025–Present

Sogang University, Republic of Korea
B.A. in Economics (GPA: 4.27/4.30)
B.S. in Mathematics (GPA: 4.05/4.30)

Aug 2025

- Ranked 1st in the School of Economics (out of 63 graduates)
- Graduated early, completing both degrees in seven semesters
- Honors in Economic Theory

FIELDS OF INTEREST

International Finance, Spatial Economics, Macroeconomics, Econometrics

WORKING PAPERS

“The Geography of Interest Rate Differences”

(with Junhee Kwak, * **First author**)

- Abstract: Documents that cross-country interest-rate differences increase systematically with geographic distance. Develops a structural portfolio-choice model in which geography affects capital allocation through bilateral distance frictions and spatially correlated destination characteristics. Estimates the model using bilateral portfolio holdings and cross-country interest-rate data, and quantifies the contribution of each geographic channel to interest-rate dispersion.

“Sensitivity Analysis in Sharp Regression Discontinuity Designs”

(with Sungwon Lee, Sukyung Joo and Beomsu Kim)

- Abstract: Develops a partial-identification framework for extrapolating causal effects beyond the cutoff in sharp regression discontinuity designs. Derives sharp bounds on average and distributional treatment effects under smoothness restrictions on potential outcome distributions, parameterized by interpretable sensitivity measures. Demonstrates the method through Monte Carlo simulations and an empirical application on external validity.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Research Center for Big Data on Korean Economy

May 2025–Present

Project: “*Revisiting the Fertility Puzzle: A Dynamic Spatial Equilibrium Approach*”

Co-PIs: **Costas Arkolakis (Yale)**, **Junhee Kwak (Sogang)**, **Hyunjoo Yang (Sogang)**

- Designed and implemented the project’s structural estimation strategy, including analytical derivations for parameter identification and estimation.
- Designed and implemented reduced-form empirical analyses, including empirical specifications, variable construction, estimation, and robustness exercises across multiple levels of geographic aggregation.
- Built and integrated administrative and geographic datasets with population-scale financial, mobility, and consumption microdata, and developed procedures to process and validate proprietary data against administrative records.

Research Assistant for Prof. Junhee Kwak (Sogang)

Mar 2025–July 2025

- Constructed a sanctions measure for the project and conducted regression analyses.

WORK IN PROGRESS

“*A Spatial Theory of Exchange Rate Disconnect*”

- Develops a multi-country model of exchange rates to study how geographic frictions shape the cross-country transmission of financial shocks.

PRESENTATIONS

Sensitivity Analysis in Sharp Regression Discontinuity Designs

- The International Symposium on Econometric Theory and Applications, Tokyo, Japan June 2026
- KER International Conference, Jeju, Republic of Korea June 2026

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant for Prof. Younghoon Lee Sep 2025 – Present

- Econometrics, Economic Statistics

Tutor, Economics Study Center, Sogang Univ Sep 2025 – Present

- Econometrics, Advanced Econometrics, Applied Econometrics, Economic Statistics

SCHOLARSHIPS / FELLOWSHIPS

Albatross Fellowship, Sogang Univ · Sep 2025– Present

Brain Korea 21-Four Fellowship, Sogang Univ · Sep 2025– Present

TA Scholarship, Sogang Univ · Sep 2025– Present

Dean's List Award ×3 Fall 2020, Spring 2021, Fall 2023

Academic Excellence Award Fall 2021

Integrated Undergrad-Grad Degree Program Scholarship · Sogang Univ. Sep 2025

OTHER ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES

Reading Groups on

- International Macroeconomics Aug 2026 – Present
- High-Dimensional Data and Machine Learning Application with Python Aug 2024 – Jan 2025

Undergraduate Economic Society, president (June 2024 - July 2025) Dec 2020 – Aug 2025

- An honor society for undergraduates pursuing doctoral studies in economics
- Organized weekly reading groups and led an annual academic event as a president

SKILLS & Certificates

Programs: Python, STATA, Julia, MATLAB, L^AT_EX

Languages: English (Fluent), Korean (Native)

Test Scores TOEFL: 5.0 (5.5) | Reading 5.5 (5.5) Listening 5.0 (5.5) Speaking 4.5 (4.5) Writing 5.0 (5.0)
GRE: Verbal 158 Quantitative 170 Writing 3.5